

Documentation-backed public edition

FIN Public Handbook

Practical role-based guidance, product value, regulatory boundaries, and trust commitments for current FIN workflows.

Reviewed 4 July 2026 · South Africa



FIN Value Proposition

Last reviewed: 2026-08-24 **Use for:** current website copy, demos, partner introductions, and sales conversations.

Approved Positioning

FIN is a financial operations platform for South African SMEs, bookkeepers, accountants, and finance teams. It helps turn bank statements, source documents, invoices, inventory and sales records, payroll, VAT, assets, and budgets into controlled accounting workflows, structured ledger records, reports, and audit trails.

FIN is designed for businesses that need better financial records and operating control throughout the year, not only when reporting or tax deadlines arrive.

The platform is in active development. This document describes capability that is built and in production use; anything not described here should not be assumed.

Origin And Direction

FIN is headquartered in South Africa, where the platform was conceived and built. Its accounting core — double-entry posting, source documents, classification, statements, inventory, and point of sale — is jurisdiction-neutral. Statutory reporting currently covers South African requirements, and that coverage extends as the team grows.

Partners should read this precisely: FIN operates today against South African statutory requirements. Support for any other jurisdiction is not present in the product and is not offered.

One-Sentence Proposition

FIN helps South African finance teams turn everyday financial records into reviewable accounting workflows and decision-ready reports.

Short Website Copy

Upload records. Review classifications. Keep the ledger current. Generate the reports your business needs.

FIN brings bookkeeping, documents, inventory and sales, payroll, VAT, assets, budgets, and reporting into one company-scoped financial operations platform.

Customer Value

Audience	Problem	FIN value
Business owners	Limited visibility and scattered records	A repeatable workflow from source records to reports
Bookkeepers	Repetitive capture and review across clients	Accounting Workbench imports, reusable classification rules, Inventory Management documents, multi-company access, and exports
Accountants and finance teams	Incomplete source records and slow report preparation	Structured ledger records, supporting reports, and audit trail
Integration partners	Need controlled external access	API-client and scoped-entitlement foundation, with enforcement work remaining
Payroll administrators	Need repeatable payroll processing and reviewed statutory outputs	Attendance review, payroll periods, custom components, payslips, postings, settlements, and preparation reports

Differentiators

Accounting Workbench

FIN supports PDF and CSV bank-statement import, document extraction with OCR fallback, transaction classification, reusable mapping rules, correction, and reconciliation. Extracted and classified records remain reviewable. In the current UI these source-record workflows live in **Accounting Workbench**, alongside cashbook, general ledger, chart-of-accounts, adjustment-entry, bulk operation, and audit-trail tools.

Inventory, Sales, And AR/AP Workflows

FIN groups customers, suppliers, AR/AP ageing and settlement, and inventory operations under **Inventory Management**; customer and supplier documents are raised in **Accounting Workbench** → **Customer & Supplier Documents**, alongside the other source documents. The module includes an item master for stock, services, non-stock items, WIP, labour, consumables, and asset purchases; stock-control workflows for locations, movements, stock counts, transfers, and write-offs; purchasing workflows for purchase orders and goods receipts; and inventory reports for valuation, reorder, and movement review. Inventory can be enabled per company by authorised users.

Point Of Sale

FIN ingests point-of-sale activity as an accounting source rather than a separate silo. Sales arrive through webhook ingestion, returns are handled as first-class movements, and a cash-up control loop reconciles what the till says against what was banked. A close-of-day routine runs on a schedule so the day is closed consistently rather than when someone remembers. Takings reach the ledger the same way every other source record does — classified, reviewable and traceable.

Document Intelligence

Uploaded documents are read line by line, not just as a total. FIN suggests an account per line using what has already been classified for that company, so the suggestions improve as the book is worked rather than staying generic. Where a document cannot be parsed — a poor scan, an unusual layout — FIN captures it

anyway and lets the lines be entered by hand, so an awkward document is never a dead end. Photographs taken on a phone are accepted, including HEIC.

Every suggestion is a suggestion: nothing posts without review.

Statements Of Account

An invoice settled in instalments across a year prints as a statement showing the invoice, every payment against it on its own date, a running balance and what is still owed, with 30/60/90-day ageing. Statements are produced for customers and suppliers alike, and can be printed or emailed from the same screen the documents live on.

Secure Document Retention (South African region)

Uploaded source documents — invoice and receipt scans, bank statements, and transaction CSVs — are retained as their original files in a private, encrypted, versioned object store hosted in the South African (Cape Town) region. They are reached only through short-lived, access-checked links and can be downloaded by authorised users from the imported-documents and transaction views. Keeping the source record alongside the resulting transactions supports review, reconciliation, and an audit trail, and supports data-residency expectations for South African businesses. FIN does not make legal or regulatory compliance guarantees.

Ledger-Backed Reporting

Operational records flow into double-entry journals and the general ledger. Customer invoice revenue resolves at line level so one invoice can credit multiple income accounts. FIN produces trial balance, general ledger, income statement, income tax computation, balance sheet, cash flow, cashbook, VAT, payroll, inventory, management, AFS, and audit-trail outputs, with PDF preview before selected bundle downloads. In the current UI, statement packs are under **Reports & AFS**; VAT, income tax computation, and payroll tax outputs are under **Tax & Compliance**.

South African Financial Operations

FIN supports South African VAT and payroll workflows, including PAYE, UIF, SDL, VAT 201 reports, and EMP201, EMP501, and IRP5-style preparation outputs. FIN has no current SARS API or eFiling connection; users export or print these reports for manual submission and stakeholder sharing. FIN does not replace professional review.

Time & Attendance supports admin clock capture, employee self-service clocking, exception review, approval/exclusion, and import of approved hours into payroll. Hours are captured and approved inside FIN; it does not connect to biometric, GPS, or external labour-service providers.

Controlled Automation

FIN uses reviewable rules, visible journal entries, company-scoped access, correction history, and audit records. Automation reduces repetitive work without hiding the accounting result.

Expandable Commercial Model

FIN tenant access is priced separately from modular add-ons, metered usage, external API licenses, and scoped integration products. Only offerings that are built and available are described as purchasable.

Positioning For Accounting And Bookkeeping Practices

FIN is built to be run by a practice across many client companies, not only by one business on its own books. Everything below exists in the product today and can be shown in a demonstration.

Many clients, one login, separate books

A practice organises client companies into **portfolios**. A portfolio is an organising container; a company is the accounting boundary. Grouping companies in one portfolio does **not** combine their ledgers, tax, payroll, or user access — each client's books stay separate. That separation is the point: it is what lets a practice take on a client without any risk of their records touching another's.

Staff reach only the clients they are assigned

Access is company-scoped, with per-company roles rather than one blanket permission. A clerk raising invoices, a bookkeeper working source documents, and a reviewing accountant can each be given what their work needs and nothing further. Access changes are recorded.

Work a junior captured, a principal can stand behind

Classification, corrections, and postings stay reviewable, and the audit trail records who did what and when. Classification rules show what they actually caught — direction and value — so a rule that has quietly been miscategorising is visible rather than buried. For a practice signing off on work it did not personally capture, reviewability is the product.

Client-facing output under the practice's control

Invoices, quotations, credit and debit notes, and statements of account carry the client company's branding and are produced from the ledger rather than re-typed. A statement shows every payment against an invoice with a running balance and ageing, which is what a client asks for when they query a balance.

The monthly book does not need re-keying twelve times

Recurring invoices and recurring expenses post on their own date. Fixed costs — rent, insurance, subscriptions — stop being a monthly capture task, and the schedule shows its next run, its last run, and how many times it has run, so an unattended job can be trusted.

What a practice should tell its own clients

FIN prepares SARS-facing reports — VAT, payroll, income tax — for review and manual submission. It does not file on a client's behalf, and no part of it should be presented as doing so. A practice keeps its

professional judgement and its filing relationship; FIN does the preparation, retention, and evidence around it.

Demonstration Narrative

1. Register on Trial or select a paid tenant plan.
2. Verify the email address and create a company.
3. Configure the fiscal period and company information.
4. Import a bank statement or business document; show per-line account suggestions and the capture-first path when a document will not parse.
5. Review classifications and create a reusable rule, then show what that rule has since caught.
6. Inspect the resulting journal and ledger records.
7. Raise an invoice, record a part payment, and print the statement of account that results.
8. Generate relevant financial, VAT, payroll, inventory, budget, or management reports.
9. Show company-scoped access, audit history, and branded document output.
10. For a practice audience: show portfolios across client companies, and a recurring invoice or expense posting on its own schedule.

Trust Language

Use:

- controlled financial workflows;
- reviewable classification and corrections;
- company-scoped access;
- ledger-backed reports;
- SARS-facing preparation support;
- private, encrypted retention of source documents in the South African region (data residency, not a compliance guarantee);
- audit-supporting records and traceability.

Avoid:

- guaranteed compliance;
- automatic SARS submission;
- guaranteed OCR or classification accuracy;
- claims of error-free operation;
- “unlimited” unless a tested limit is genuinely absent;
- unsupported production statistics or customer outcomes;
- statements of future capability, roadmap items, or intended integrations — this document describes what is built and running, and nothing else;
- any suggestion that statutory coverage outside South Africa exists today;
- descriptions of internal architecture, implementation mechanism, or infrastructure design — state the outcome a customer gets, not how it is built.

Commercial References

- [Business model](#)
- [Supported use cases](#)
- [Pricing and licensing](#)
- [Regulatory reporting boundary](#)
- [Product capability and readiness](#)
- [Customer roles and lifecycle](#)
- [Trust, support and operating boundaries](#)

FIN Manual — General Users

For: staff who use FIN for specific tasks (not full accounting). **Status:** task steps drafted from the live UI; screenshots still to be added in `images/`.

FIN automates internal calculations, postings, controls, and report generation. Documents and reports you download are for your records or **manual** submission/sharing — FIN does not file to SARS.

1. Getting started

To sign in:

1. Go to `https://sthwalo.com/fin` and log in with your email and password.
2. First time: open the **verification email** and confirm your address before logging in.
3. Forgot your password? Use **Forgot password** on the login screen and follow the reset link.
4. Enter the one-time MFA code sent to your account email after your password is accepted.

Staying signed in: sessions end after ~30 minutes of inactivity. About 30 seconds before, a warning appears — click **Stay Logged In** to continue, or you'll be signed out automatically and returned to the login screen.

2. Find your way around

1. Use the **sidebar** to move between areas, grouped as **Command**, **Accounting Flow**, and **People**.
The current labels are **Business Overview** (company admins), **Entity & Period Setup**, **Accounting Workbench**, **Inventory Management**, **Tax & Compliance**, **Fixed Assets**, **Budgets & Forecasts**, **Reports & AFS**, **Payroll**, and **Account, Billing & Access**. Platform super-admins also see **Platform Control**. Company admins land on **Business Overview** by default — an at-a-glance view of their own companies. (If you used an earlier version: **VAT Management** is now **Tax & Compliance**, **Asset Register** / **Asset Management** is now **Fixed Assets**, **Management Report** / **Financial Reports** are combined into **Reports & AFS**, and bank/source workflows are in **Accounting Workbench**. **Sales Documents** has moved out of **Inventory Management** and is now **Customer & Supplier Documents** under **Accounting Workbench** → **Upload** — it covers customer invoices, quotations, credit and debit notes, supplier invoices and purchase orders, which are all source documents.)
2. Always check the **company** and **fiscal period** selectors at the top — what you see and create belongs to that context.

3. Raise a document and download its PDF

To create a quotation or invoice:

1. Open **Accounting Workbench** → **Upload** → **Customer & Supplier Documents** and choose **Create Invoice**.

2. Pick the **document type** (e.g. Sales Invoice, Customer Quotation, Supplier Invoice, Purchase Order).
3. Enter the party (customer/supplier), date, and line items; the document number is generated for you.
4. Save — the document is created and (for posting types) its journal entry is recorded automatically.

To download/print:

1. In the **Accounting Workbench** → **Upload** → **Customer & Supplier Documents** list, use the per-row **PDF** action to download/print.
2. Use the per-row **Email** action to send a document straight to the customer/supplier.

To send a customer a statement of account:

1. In **Customer & Supplier Documents**, open the **Statements** tab.
2. Choose **Customer** (or **Supplier**), pick the account, and set the **From** and **To** dates.
3. Click **Build statement**. You will see every invoice and every payment in date order, with a running balance, the balance due, and a 30/60/90-day age analysis.
4. **Print** opens the statement as a PDF; **Email** sends it to the address on file (you can change the recipient before it goes).

4. Upload an invoice or receipt

1. Open **Accounting Workbench** → **Upload** → **Upload Files** and add a PDF/image of the invoice or receipt.
2. FIN extracts the vendor, amount, and VAT; check it under **Upload** → **Imported Documents** and fix any mis-read fields. Documents dated outside the selected fiscal period are rejected — pick the right period.

5. Download payslips and reports

1. Payslips: **Payroll Management** → select the employee/period → download the payslip PDF.
2. Reports: **Reports & AFS** → pick a tab (Management Metrics, Monthly Accounts, TB, Income Statement, Balance Sheet, Cash Flow Statement, AFS), choose the required report period, preview, then download as PDF/CSV/XLSX. Saved page/workspace state is restored after a browser refresh. The **General Ledger** and **Cashbook** are under **Accounting Workbench**. Tax returns (VAT 201, EMP201/EMP501) are under **Tax & Compliance**.

6. Account settings

1. In **Account, Billing & Access**, update your profile and password.
2. Your available companies and what you can do in each are set by your administrator.

7. Getting help

1. Raise a **support ticket** from the app for issues.

2. If you can't see a company or perform an action, ask your **administrator** — per-company permissions are managed under **Account, Billing & Access** → **Company Access Assignments**.

FIN Manual — Business Owners & Managers

For: owners/managers who configure the company, manage the team and billing, and consume reports.

Status: task steps drafted from the live UI; screenshots still to be added in `images/`.

FIN automates internal calculations, postings, controls, and report generation. It is **not** connected to a SARS API or SARS eFiling — reports are exported or printed for manual submission or stakeholder sharing.

1. Sign in and choose your workspace

1. Sign in at `https://sthwalo.com/fin`.
2. Pick the **company** and **fiscal period** in the selectors at the top — every screen acts on the selected context. Entity & Period Setup provides searchable directories and status filters when the practice has many companies or periods.
3. If you're away for ~30 minutes you'll be signed out automatically; a warning appears ~30 seconds before, where you can choose **Stay Logged In**.

2. Create and configure a company

To set up a new company:

1. Open **Entity & Period Setup** and create the company.
2. Enter the legal name, **registration and tax/VAT numbers**, and contact details.
3. Add **directors** (used on Annual Financial Statements).
4. Select the **industry** — this offers a starting chart-of-accounts template.
5. Set the **fiscal periods** and **year-end month**.

To organise an accounting practice: create or configure a portfolio in **Entity & Period Setup**. Choose **Standalone client** for one company, **Multiple unrelated client companies** for independent clients managed by the same practice, or **Corporate group** for related entities. Changing the structure retains selected existing members and validates the final company count; portfolio membership does not grant users access to those companies.

3. Branding and report profiles

To brand the app and PDFs:

1. In **Entity & Period Setup**, open a company's **Company Branding** modal, set the brand colours, and enable the custom theme (the card shows **Custom brand active** vs **Default FIN brand**).
2. Company branding flows to the app UI and is the standard PDF fallback.
3. In **Reports & AFS**, choose or configure a **report profile** to control logo visibility, company/custom/platform-default colours, and the ticked sections in internal management or external financial packs.

4. Mark a profile as the **default** for Financial, Management, or AFS PDFs so exports use it automatically.
5. Note: AFS branding is limited to headers/footers so the statement text stays black and readable.
6. Accountants can edit or reset the independent accountant's report, directors'/members' report, statement of responsibility and notes. Defaults are seeded for each company.

4. Invite your team and assign access

To add a teammate (Account, Billing & Access):

1. Open **Account, Billing & Access** → **Team Management** and enter the person's email to **invite** them. Inviting adds them to your subscription's shared **seat pool** (ADMIN/SUPER_ADMIN on a paid plan; seat-limited).
2. They receive an email link to create their account.

To grant what they can do per company:

1. In **Account, Billing & Access** → **Company Access Assignments**, pick the invited member.
2. Start from a **role preset**, then tick the exact permissions they need **for the selected company**.
3. Access is **per company**, not organisation-wide — repeat per company you want them in.

5. Plans and billing

To manage your subscription:

1. Review your plan and **seats used** in **Account, Billing & Access**.
2. Tenant access plans: **Trial (R0)**, **Starter (R349/mo)**, **Professional (R899/mo)**, **Enterprise (R2,499/mo)**. Modular add-ons, usage charges, and API licences are priced separately.
3. Upgrade/cancel through **Paystack**; activation completes when the payment notification is confirmed.
4. See [Pricing and licensing](#) and the [partner integration guide](#).

6. Dashboards and reports

To review the business:

1. Open **Business Overview** for the high-level view of your companies (metrics + data controls). (Platform super-admins also have a separate **Platform Control** area.)
2. Open **Reports & AFS** — the accounting statements as tabs: **Management Metrics** (KPIs, cash flow, aged analysis; **preview** the bundle before downloading), **Monthly Accounts**, **TB**, **Income Statement**, **Balance Sheet**, **Cash Flow Statement** (which ends with cash at the end of the period), and **AFS**. The **Cashbook** and **General Ledger** are under **Accounting Workbench**, and **Audit Trail** is under **Accounting Workbench** → **Operations**.
3. For tax outputs, open **Tax & Compliance** — **VAT**, **Income Tax Computation**, **Payroll Taxes** (EMP201 / EMP501), and **Other Taxes**.
4. Choose a month, quarter, YTD, comparative range or full year before previewing a pack. Only the profile sections left ticked are included; full-year AFS remains available.

5. Toggle **Comparative** on a statement to get month-by-month columns instead of a single cumulative column.
6. Export to **PDF / CSV / XLSX**; remember these are for your records or **manual** SARS submission.

7. Inventory and operational documents

To review inventory, sales, customers, and suppliers:

1. Open **Inventory Management** → **Overview**. If inventory is off, the page still gives access to customers, suppliers, AR, and AP; users with inventory permission can enable inventory tracking for item, stock, valuation, purchasing, and reporting workflows.
2. Use **Accounting Workbench** → **Upload** → **Customer & Supplier Documents** for invoices, quotations, credit/debit notes, supplier invoices, and purchase orders.
3. Use **Customers & Receivables** and **Suppliers & Payables** to review customer/supplier records, ageing, and settlement capture.
4. Use **Inventory Reports** for stock valuation, reorder, and movement reporting once inventory is enabled.
5. Use **POS** if you trade from a till: sales and returns come in from the connected point of sale, and a daily cash-up records what was banked against what the till took, so the difference is visible on the day rather than at month-end.

To send a customer their statement: in **Customer & Supplier Documents**, open the **Statements** tab, pick the customer and a date range, and build the statement. It shows each invoice, each payment against it, the balance due, and how overdue it is. Print it or email it from the same screen.

To stop capturing the same costs every month: in **Accounting Workbench** → **Upload** → **Recurring Expenses**, schedule rent, insurance, or subscriptions once and FIN posts them on their date. The same applies to invoices you raise every month — set the repeat when you create the invoice.

8. Budgets and strategic plans

To review plans and forecasts:

1. Open **Budgets & Forecasts** and select or create a budget for the fiscal year.
2. Review the tabs: **Overview**, **Line Items**, **Projections**, **Assumptions**, **Initiatives & Milestones**, **Monthly Activities**, and **Strategic Plan**.
3. Use **Export Strategic Plan PDF** to download the strategic plan pack for review or sharing.

9. Support

To get help: raise a **support ticket** from the app. For access problems, your ADMIN controls per-company permissions (Section 4).

FIN Manual — Bookkeepers

For: bookkeepers doing day-to-day capture and reconciliation. **Status:** task steps drafted from the live UI; screenshots still to be added in `images/`.

FIN automates internal calculations, postings, controls, and report generation. It is not connected to a SARS API or SARS eFiling. Payroll and VAT outputs are exported or printed for manual submission or stakeholder sharing.

1. Daily workflow overview

1. Sign in at `https://sthwalo.com/fin`.
2. Select the **company** and **fiscal period** at the top of the screen.
3. Most source-record, classification, cashbook, ledger, and housekeeping tasks live under **Accounting Workbench**. Sales/supplier documents, customers, suppliers, AR/AP, and inventory workflows live under **Inventory Management**.

2. Bank statements

To import a bank statement:

1. Go to **Accounting Workbench** → **Upload** → **Upload Files**.
2. Drop or browse to upload a **PDF** or **CSV** statement.
3. Wait for processing (text/OCR extraction), then review the results under **Imported Transactions**.

3. Transaction classification

To classify transactions:

1. Open **Accounting Workbench** → **Transaction Classification**.
2. For each line, set the **Debit Account** and **Credit Account**; unclassified rows show **Not classified**.
3. Double-click an account in the account picker to apply a manual classification immediately.
4. To auto-handle recurring items, create a **classification rule** so similar transactions classify automatically next time.
5. In rule creation, double-click an account to select it and create the rule in one action.
6. Use **Accounting Workbench** → **Operations** → **View Classification Summary** to confirm nothing is left unclassified.

Classification Review is for working the queue, not for capturing entries. Each line offers **Accept Suggestion**, **Create Rule**, and **Not a transaction** (for a balance brought forward or a mis-parsed line). Set accounts by hand on the classification list above, or through an adjustment entry — Review no longer duplicates that.

4. Customer invoices & documents

To raise and download documents (Accounting Workbench → Upload → Customer & Supplier Documents):

1. Use **Create Invoice** and pick the document type (Sales Invoice, Customer Quotation, Supplier Invoice, Purchase Order, etc.); add line items, discounts, and VAT as required.
2. For customer invoices, leave the line income account as **Auto** unless you need to override it. FIN resolves each line description to an income account and posts grouped revenue credits.
3. Quotations and purchase orders are **non-posting** (document-only).
4. The list separates **Invoices / Quotations / Credit & Debit Notes / Supplier Invoices / Purchase Orders** into tabs; use the per-row **PDF** action to download/print and **Email** to send it.
5. Customer and supplier ledgers are under **Inventory Management → Customers & Receivables** and **Inventory Management → Suppliers & Payables** for ageing and settlement capture.
6. If invoices were edited in bulk, run **Accounting Workbench → Operations → Sync Invoice Journal Entries**.

To produce a statement of account: open the **Statements** tab in the same screen, choose the customer or supplier and a date range, and click **Build statement**. It lists every invoice and every payment in date order with a running balance, the balance due, and 30/60/90-day ageing. **Print** produces the PDF; **Email** sends it to the address on file.

To record a part payment: open the invoice and record the amount actually received or paid. The invoice stays payable at its remaining balance and its status becomes **Partial**. Each payment is recorded separately, which is what the statement then shows. A payment larger than the balance outstanding is refused rather than accepted and trimmed — check the figure and re-enter it.

To stop re-keying a monthly cost: in **Accounting Workbench → Upload → Recurring Expenses**, schedule rent, insurance, or a subscription once. Choose the expense account and supplier (both come from what already exists in Inventory Management and the chart of accounts), the amount, and the frequency. FIN posts it on its due date and shows the next run, the last run, and how many times it has run so you can confirm it is working.

5. Inventory, purchasing, and stock

To use Inventory Management:

1. Open **Inventory Management**. If inventory is not enabled for the company, users with `INVENTORY_MANAGE` permission can click **Enable Inventory**.
2. Use **Items & Services** for the item master: stock, services, non-stock items, WIP, labour, consumables, and asset purchases.
3. Use **Stock Control** for locations, stock levels, movements, counts, transfers, and write-offs.
4. Use **Purchases** for purchase orders and goods receipts. Invoices, quotations, credit and debit notes, supplier invoices, and purchase orders are raised in **Accounting Workbench → Upload → Customer & Supplier Documents**.
5. Set each item's **unit of measure** — each, hour, kilogram, litre, metre and so on. It carries through to documents, stock movements, and valuation, so a quantity always states what it counts.

6. Use **Inventory Reports** to review valuation, reorder, and movement information.

To handle till takings (Point of Sale): open **Inventory Management** → **POS**. Sales arrive from the connected till, and returns are recorded as returns rather than negative sales. At the end of trading, use the **cash-up** to compare what the till recorded against what was actually banked and record the difference; a close-of-day routine also runs on a schedule so a day is not left open because someone forgot. Takings reach the ledger as classified, reviewable records like any other source.

6. Payroll capture

Adding employees: each employee has a **Salary Type / pay frequency** — **Monthly, Bi-Monthly (fortnightly), Weekly, Daily, or Hourly** — which determines how PAYE, UIF and SDL are annualised; **basicSalary** is the gross for one period of that frequency. The **Tax Number** is **optional at creation** so salaries can be processed before SARS registration; employees still missing one are flagged on the employee list (and can be filtered) so you can chase them before a SARS run.

To process a payroll run:

1. Open **Payroll Management**, search/filter the period directory if needed, select the payroll period, and confirm employees.
2. If attendance is used, open **Time & Attendance** from Payroll Management, record or review clock events, load **Exceptions**, approve or exclude daily summaries, then **Import approved hours** into the payroll period.
3. Use **Category Inputs, Pay Components, and Adjustments** for per-period overtime, allowances, deductions, custom employer components, or durable net-pay corrections.
4. Process or **reprocess** the run and generate **payslips**.
5. From **Payroll Management** → **View reports**, generate the branded **Pay Register, Payroll Summary, EMP201, EMP501, and IRP5 / IT3(a)** PDFs for accountant review and **manual external submission or stakeholder sharing**. In that report panel you can choose a **scope (Monthly, Year to date, or Yearly)** and filter to **a single employee or all employees**. FIN does not submit these reports to SARS.
6. **EMP201** and **EMP501** can also be generated from **Tax & Compliance** → **Payroll Taxes** (pick a processed payroll period).

To apply a net-pay adjustment (e.g. a 1-cent reconciliation): in **Payroll Management**, select the period and open **Adjustments**. Pick the employee, choose **Earning** (increases net pay) or **Deduction** (decreases it), enter the amount and an optional reason, and **Add adjustment**. Then **reprocess** the period to apply it. Adjustments are stored per employee/period and are **reapplied on every reprocess** (unlike a manual payslip edit, which is wiped on reprocess); they change net pay only — PAYE/UIF/SDL are not recalculated. Note: to correct an actual **salary**, change the employee's basic salary instead (it is effective-dated and applies to the periods it covers on reprocess).

7. Imported documents (OCR)

To review scanned invoices/receipts: open **Accounting Workbench** → **Upload** → **Imported Documents**, then open the assisted review workbench. Compare the source with the captured header and

lines, correct vendor/account/amount details, remove empty or balance-brought-forward lines, and accept individual lines or all reviewed lines. Corrections teach the resolver for later documents. Post only after review; when a paid document is linked to a bank transaction FIN uses Purchases Clearing so the bank cash movement is not duplicated.

FIN suggests an account **per line**, learning from what has already been classified for that company, so suggestions sharpen as the book is worked. If a document will not parse — a poor scan or an unusual layout — FIN still captures it and you enter the lines by hand, so an awkward document is never a dead end. Photographs taken on a phone are accepted, including HEIC. Every suggestion is only a suggestion: nothing posts until you accept it.

8. Housekeeping

Under **Accounting Workbench** → **Operations** (the "Bulk Operations" panel):

- **Reset Classification Setup** — start classification configuration over.
- **Sync Journal Entries / Regenerate All Journal Entries** — fix GL drift after corrections.
- **Reset Period Data** — clear period data when re-importing (use with care; confirm the company and period first).

FIN Manual — Accountants

For: accountants responsible for the full accounting cycle and statutory outputs. **Status:** task steps drafted from the live UI; screenshots still to be added in `images/`.

FIN automates internal calculations, postings, controls, and report generation. It is not connected to a SARS API or SARS eFiling. You review, export or print, and manually submit regulatory reports or share them with stakeholders. FIN does not replace professional review.

1. Getting oriented

To set your working context:

1. Sign in at `https://sthwalo.com/fin`.
2. Use the **company selector** and **fiscal period** selector at the top of every screen.
3. Confirm your role: **ADMIN** can manage company setup, users, and billing; **USER** works within granted features. Accountants typically need ADMIN to reach **Entity & Period Setup** and **Account, Billing & Access**.

If you carry a client book: organise client companies into **portfolios**. A portfolio is an organising container; the **company** is the accounting boundary. Grouping companies in one portfolio does **not** combine their ledgers, tax, payroll, or user access — each client's records stay separate, and staff see only the companies they are assigned. An unassigned company still works normally; the warning only means it has no portfolio grouping.

The left navigation is grouped into **Command**, **Accounting Flow**, and **People**. Current labels include **Platform Control** (platform super-admins), **Business Overview** (company admins), **Entity & Period Setup**, **Accounting Workbench**, **Inventory Management**, **Tax & Compliance**, **Fixed Assets**, **Budgets & Forecasts**, **Reports & AFS**, **Payroll**, **Account, Billing & Access**, and **System Clock / Audit & System Logs** where the user's role allows them. Company admins land on **Business Overview** by default — their own company metrics (companies, team seats, transactions, employees, fiscal periods, plan) plus a Data Controls tab; it shows no platform/system data.

Recently reorganised — where things moved: the old **Financial Reports** page is gone; its statements now live as tabs inside **Reports & AFS**. **Management Report** is now **Reports & AFS** (its dashboard is the **Management Metrics** tab). **VAT Management** is now **Tax & Compliance** (tabs: **VAT**, **Income Tax Computation**, **Payroll Taxes**, **Other Taxes**). **Asset Register / Asset Management** is now **Fixed Assets**. Bank/source workflows are in **Accounting Workbench**. Customer and supplier documents live in the Accounting Workbench too; customers, suppliers, AR/AP, and inventory workflows are in **Inventory Management**. **Cashbook** and **General Ledger** are tabs in **Accounting Workbench**, and **Audit Trail** is under **Accounting Workbench** → **Operations**.

2. Chart of Accounts

- Account types & codes: Assets 1xxx, Liabilities 2xxx, Equity 3xxx, Revenue 4xxx, Cost of Sales 5xxx, Expenses 6xxx.
- Contra accounts: Sales Returns 4080, Purchases Returns 5080.

To review the chart of accounts: open **Accounting Workbench** → **Chart of Accounts** and review the account list for the selected company and period before classifying transactions.

3. Journals & the General Ledger

To capture a manual journal:

1. Go to **Accounting Workbench** → **Adjustment Entry**.
2. Enter the date, description, **Debit Account**, **Credit Account**, and amount; keep the entry balanced.
3. Save. The entry posts to the general ledger for the active company and period.

To edit or delete an adjustment: the Adjustment Entry tab lists the period's manual entries.

- **Edit** posts a reversal of the original (kept in the audit trail) and reopens the form prefilled, so you record a corrected replacement — posted entries are never silently mutated.
- **Delete** removes a manual entry and its lines (admin only; entries linked to bank transactions cannot be deleted — reclassify the source transaction instead).
- Entries already reversed are shown as such and are not editable or deletable again.

To keep the ledger consistent after bulk changes: use **Accounting Workbench** → **Operations** (the "Bulk Operations" panel):

- **Sync Journal Entries / Sync Invoice Journal Entries** — align documents and the GL.
- **Regenerate All Journal Entries** — rebuild postings after large corrections.
- **View Classification Summary** — confirm coverage before reporting.

To review results: check **Accounting Workbench** → **General Ledger** and **Reports & AFS** → **TB**.

Customer invoice revenue is posted at line level. One invoice can credit multiple income accounts; the invoice total debits Trade Debtors, while line net amounts are grouped by resolved income account and credited separately. Lines with no confident match use the fallback income account and are flagged for review rather than silently being treated as correctly resolved.

4. Documents

- Posting documents (invoice, credit/debit note, returns, refund) create accounting effects.
- Quotations and purchase orders are non-posting (document-only).
- Create and manage documents under **Accounting Workbench** → **Upload** → **Customer & Supplier Documents**; the list separates **Invoices**, **Quotations**, **Credit & Debit Notes**, **Supplier Invoices**, and **Purchase Orders** into tabs. Use the per-row **PDF** action to download/print and **Email** to send to the customer/supplier.

- Customer and supplier ledgers are now **Inventory Management** → **Customers & Receivables** and **Inventory Management** → **Suppliers & Payables** for aged receivables/payables and settlement capture.

5. Taxes (VAT, income tax, payroll taxes)

All tax workflows live under **Tax & Compliance**, which has four tabs: **VAT**, **Income Tax Computation**, **Payroll Taxes**, and **Other Taxes**.

To prepare a VAT return:

1. Open **Tax & Compliance** → **VAT** and confirm the VAT period (monthly / bi-monthly) and configuration.
2. Generate and review the **VAT 201** report with its supporting schedules (PDF).
3. Export or print the VAT 201 for **manual submission to SARS**.
4. Record the external SARS payment, reference, and settlement in FIN.

To prepare payroll taxes (EMP201 / EMP501): open **Tax & Compliance** → **Payroll Taxes**, choose a processed payroll period, and generate the branded **EMP201** (monthly PAYE/SDL/UIF return, current + year-to-date) or **EMP501** (annual reconciliation) PDF. (These are also available from Payroll Management; see the payroll/bookkeeper manuals.)

For the income-tax schedule: use **Tax & Compliance** → **Income Tax Computation** (see section 6).

FIN does not connect to SARS or submit any of these through an API — you review, export/print, and submit manually.

6. Reports & statements

To produce statutory and review outputs: open **Reports & AFS**. Its tabs are, in order: **Management Metrics**, **Monthly Accounts**, **TB**, **Income Statement**, **Balance Sheet**, **Cash Flow Statement**, **AFS**.

- Use **TB**, **Income Statement**, **Balance Sheet**, **Cash Flow Statement** for the core statements. The **General Ledger** and **Cashbook** now live in **Accounting Workbench** (their own tabs), and the period's posting trail (**Audit Trail**) is in **Accounting Workbench** → **Operations**.
- **AFS** (Annual Financial Statements): use **Preview AFS** to review the selected AFS profile before download; AFS branding is limited to header/footer chrome while financial text and amounts remain black for readability.
- In the AFS configuration, edit or reset the seeded **Independent Accountant's Report**, **Directors/Members Report**, **Statement of Responsibility**, and **Notes to Financial Statements**. Wording is company-specific; financial figures still come from the ledger.
- Use **Management Metrics** for the KPI / management pack. Use **Preview Bundle / Download Bundle** to review and export the profile-driven bundle as **PDF or XLSX** — monthly accounts, the internal management pack, and the AFS all offer both. Configure internal management and external financial packs here; statement tabs no longer duplicate bundle controls.
- Set the **scope** (month, quarter, year-to-date, comparative, or full year) once for the bundle and every included section reports that window — a monthly pack shows that month's figures, not the year's under a month's heading, and annual-statement sections are left out of a sub-year pack.

- Every report shares one presentation: the same type, spacing and rules as the AFS, rules sized to the figures they close off, and portrait unless the columns genuinely need landscape. A one-month trial balance therefore prints portrait alongside the statements; a twelve-month one turns landscape by itself.
- Management figures read from the same trial balance as the statements, so a management pack and the trial balance for the same scope agree. **If you are comparing a management pack against one produced before 7 August 2026 for a company with prior-year history, expect the newer figures to be higher.** Management sections previously opened every account at nil instead of carrying the prior year forward, so totals, ratios and budget actuals were understated by the whole of that history. The trial balance, income statement, balance sheet and AFS were never affected.
- Before preview/download choose month, quarter, YTD, comparative, or full-year scope. The same scope applies throughout the pack and unticked profile sections are excluded.
- For the taxable-income schedule (manual adjustment placeholders), use **Tax & Compliance** → **Income Tax Computation** (moved out of the financial statements).
- Export each statement to **PDF / CSV / XLSX**.

Statements of account. In **Accounting Workbench** → **Upload** → **Customer & Supplier Documents**, the **Statements** tab produces a statement for any customer or supplier over a chosen period: opening balance, every invoice and payment in date order with a running balance, closing balance, and 30/60/90-day ageing measured from each invoice's due date. Movements before the period start are carried into the opening balance rather than dropped, so a statement that begins mid-history still reconciles. Purchase orders are excluded — a commitment is not a debt. Print or email it from the same screen.

Partial settlement is supported on both sides: an invoice can be paid in instalments and each payment is recorded with its own date, which is what the statement lists.

7. Assets & depreciation

To review the asset position: open **Fixed Assets**.

1. Confirm capitalisation, depreciation method (straight-line / declining balance), and useful life.
2. Generate the year-by-year depreciation schedule PDF (computed from purchase date).
3. Confirm depreciation and disposal postings appear in the ledger.

8. Inventory, AR/AP, and purchasing controls

To review inventory and trading ledgers: open **Inventory Management**.

1. Use **Items & Services** to review the item master across stock, services, non-stock items, WIP, labour, consumables, and asset purchases.
2. Use **Stock Control** and **Adjustments** to review locations, movements, stock counts, transfers, write-offs, and stock corrections when inventory is enabled.
3. Use **Purchases** for purchase orders and goods receipts.
4. Use **Customers & Receivables** and **Suppliers & Payables** for customer/supplier ledgers, ageing, and settlement capture.
5. Use **Inventory Reports** for valuation, reorder, and movement reports.

9. Budgets, forecasts, and strategic plans

To review budgets: open **Budgets & Forecasts**.

1. Select the budget for the fiscal year and review **Overview**, **Line Items**, **Projections**, **Assumptions**, **Initiatives & Milestones**, **Monthly Activities**, and **Strategic Plan**.
2. Use **Export Strategic Plan PDF** for the planning pack.
3. Use budget variance outputs to compare budgeted and actual results where available.

10. Year-end

1. Reconcile the trial balance and review the audit trail for the period.
2. Confirm asset depreciation and VAT settlements are posted.
3. Lock the fiscal period after review (use the searchable Fiscal Period directory); locked periods reject accounting mutations. Reopen only with appropriate authority when correction is required.
4. Produce and sign off the AFS.

Regulatory Reporting Boundary

Last reviewed: 2026-06-06

FIN is not currently connected to a SARS API or SARS eFiling. External SARS automation is a work in progress and must not be described as a current capability.

What FIN Automates Internally

FIN automates internal financial workflows such as payroll and VAT calculations, accounting postings, schedules, controls, settlements recorded in the ledger, and report generation.

FIN can generate SARS-facing outputs including EMP201, EMP501, IRP5-style, VAT 201, and ITR14 / Small Business Corporation (section 12E) income-tax preparation outputs, submission packs whose figures are locked with a checksum, and a SARS e@syFile IRP5/IT3(a) certificate file for manual import. These outputs remain subject to review by the responsible business or finance professional.

What Users Do Externally

Users export or print the relevant reports, manually submit or deliver them to SARS, and share them with other stakeholders when necessary. Users may then record the external payment, submission status, date, or SARS reference in FIN.

An internal status such as **SUBMITTED**, or a SARS reference stored in FIN, records an action that happened outside FIN. It does not mean FIN transmitted data to SARS.

Documentation And Product Language

- Say that FIN prepares or generates SARS-facing reports.
- Say that FIN automates internal calculations, postings, controls, and report generation.
- Say that users export or print reports for manual submission and stakeholder sharing.
- Do not say or imply that FIN connects to SARS, submits returns automatically, guarantees compliance, or replaces professional review.
- Do not describe any external integration that is not implemented, tested, and in production use.

The boundary above is the whole of the public position. No external submission or filing connection exists in FIN today, and none should be described to a customer or partner as forthcoming.

Trust, Support And Operating Boundaries

Last reviewed: 2026-06-06 **Production deployment:** current implemented trust, support, billing, and operating workflows deployed on 2026-06-06.

This document defines the business promises that the current product can support and the promises that require additional legal, operational, or technical work.

Current Trust Foundations

Area	Current product foundation	Boundary
Company data separation	Each company's records are reachable only by the people granted access to that company; a practice's client books stay separate from one another	Authorization coverage must continue to be tested across every workflow
Authentication	Production-deployed HttpOnly cookie authentication, refresh-token revocation, logout everywhere, password reset, and email MFA for all active users	Bearer/API-key request authentication is not currently active; customer endpoint/device governance remains necessary
Legal acceptance	Versioned registration acceptance records with source, time, IP address, and user agent	The repository does not establish that every required customer contract or policy is legally complete
Audit support	Audit events, accounting audit trail, correction history, email logs, system logs, and payment events	Audit-supporting records do not constitute an external audit opinion
Data review	Visible classifications, journals, reports, and correction workflows	FIN does not guarantee OCR, classification, accounting, tax, or report accuracy
Data exports	Financial and transaction outputs in supported PDF/CSV/XLSX formats	A complete automated tenant data-portability package is not documented
Account deletion	Admin-operated hard deletion after a six-month inactivity gate and subscription cancellation	Immediate self-service deletion is not implemented
Backup operations	Backup services and administrator backup access exist	Customer-facing recovery objectives and contractual restore guarantees are not published

Support Model

Authenticated users can create support tickets with categories, priorities, comments, and status tracking. FIN administrators can review tickets, comment, and update status.

The Enterprise plan contains a `has_priority_support` feature flag, but differentiated queueing, response times, resolution targets, service credits, support hours, and escalation commitments are not documented as implemented. Do not publish a support SLA until the operational process and contractual terms exist.

Billing And Commercial Boundaries

- Paystack supports current tenant-subscription initiation, payment notification, plan changes, and cancellation workflows.
- Cancellation stops renewal and retains access until the current billing-period end.
- Published prices are monthly ZAR prices.
- Annual billing logic exists in backend abstractions, but no approved annual price or discount is published in the current catalogue.
- Automated refunds, customer tax invoices, failed-payment dunning, usage invoicing, add-on purchase, and billing-grade usage reconciliation are not documented as complete.
- Priority support, API licences, add-ons, and metered usage must not be sold beyond their stated readiness status.

External-Service Boundaries

FIN depends on or may interact with external services only where implemented and configured. A provider mention does not create a guarantee of availability, approval, or successful delivery.

External area	Current position
Paystack	Production-deployed tenant-subscription payment provider workflow
Business-document and verification email	Production-deployed email workflows; successful external delivery depends on configured mail services and recipient systems
SARS and eFiling	No connection; reviewed reports are submitted manually
Bank feeds	No direct feed; supported statements are imported from files
CIPC and labour-related services	No connection; these records are captured in FIN directly
Integration partners	API-client and entitlement foundation exists; enforcement and usage coverage remain incomplete

Claims Requiring Separate Approval

The following require legal, operational, security, and product approval before publication:

- uptime, availability, recovery-time, or recovery-point guarantees;
- support response or resolution SLAs;
- guaranteed compliance, accuracy, savings, or business outcomes;
- automated regulatory submission or provider connectivity;
- certifications, endorsements, accreditations, or regulator approval;
- complete data portability, retention, deletion, or residency guarantees;
- automatic refunds, tax invoicing, or billing reconciliation;
- unlimited usage or capacity.

Responsible Positioning

FIN may be described as a controlled, company-scoped financial operations platform with reviewable workflows, ledger-backed reports, audit-supporting records, and current subscription management. It must

not be positioned as a substitute for professional review or as providing unimplemented contractual guarantees.